NEWBIES FROM THE EAST

ODISHA

BAIJAYANT JAY PANDA
From: BJD to BJP in March 2019
USP: From trusted lieutenant of Naveen Patnaik to bête noire, Panda is now part of BJP's national team



BALABHADRA MAJHI
From: BJD to BJP in 2019
USP: Was sitting MLA from Nabrangpur when he was denied ticket in 2019. Could not win as BJP candidate

PRATYUSHA RAJESHWARI SINGH
From: BJD to BJP in March 2019
USP: Former BJD MP is now the saffron party's state vice-president

SANJEEB KUMAR SAHOO
From: BJD to BJP in November 2021
USP: Four-time MLA is a confidant of CM's friend-turned-foe Pyari Mohan Mohapatra

ANJALI BEHERA
From: BJD to BJP in October 2021
USP: Two-time MLA left BJD in 2014. Will possibly be a BJP candidate from Dhenkanal area in 2024

BIHAR

MISRI LAL YADAV
From: VIP to BJP in March 2022
USP: He along with other VIP MLAs Raju Singh and Swarna Singh joined the BJP, making the party, although briefly, the single largest party in Bihar for the first time ever

RAM KIRPAL YADAV
From: RJD to BJP in March 2014
USP: Was practically No. 2 in RJD, a close confidant of Lalu Prasad Yadav. Was minister in Modi 1.0. and continues to be MP from Pataliputra

NUTAN SINGH
From: LJP to BJP in March 2021
USP: She was the lone MLC from LJP. Party has no presence now in the Bihar Legislative Council

JHARKHAND

★ ARJUN MUNDA
From: JMM to BJP in 1998
USP: Tribal face in '90s gave BJP an opening in erstwhile Bihar (now Jharkhand)

BABULAL MARANDI
From: Jharkhand Vikas Party to BJP in February 2020
USP: The state's first CM merged his party with the BJP and became chief of state legislative unit. Returned to the saffron fold after 14 years outside and is now BJP's tribal face again

★ ANNAPURNA DEVI
From: RJD to BJP in March 2019
USP: Former state RJD chief is now MP from Koderma and the Union MoS, ministry of education

WEST BENGAL

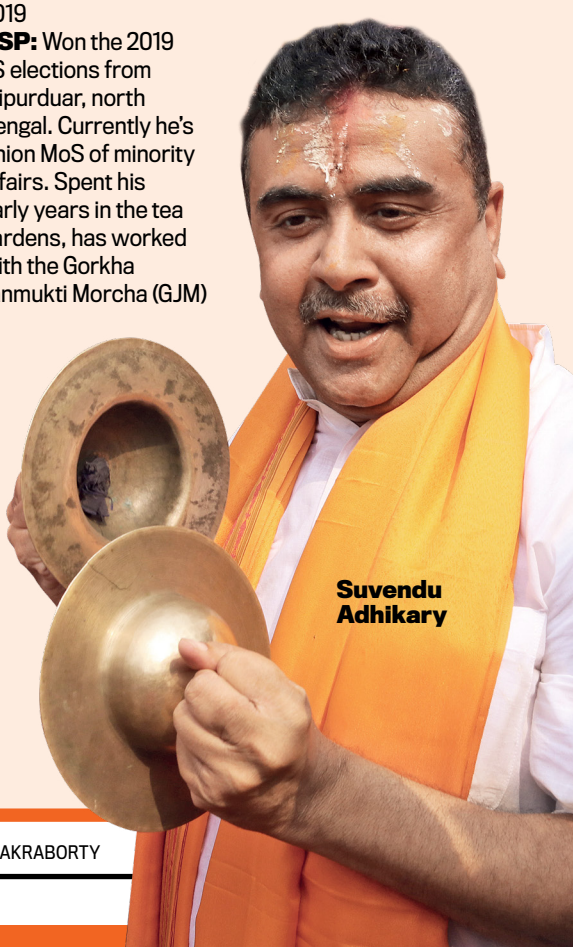
SUVENDU ADHIKARY
From: TMC to BJP in December 2020
USP: The former No. 2 to chief minister Mamata Banerjee, he defeated her in the assembly polls. He is leader of the party's legislative unit

★ NISITH PRAMANIK
From: TMC to BJP
USP: A formidable leader in the Cooch Behar region of the state. He switched over from the TMC's youth wing to become Union MoS for home affairs, sports and youth affairs

★ JOHN BARLA
From: TMC to BJP in 2019
USP: Won the 2019 LS elections from Alipurduar, north Bengal. Currently he's Union MoS of minority affairs. Spent his early years in the tea gardens, has worked with the Gorkha Janmukti Morcha (GJM) and the Jharkhand Mukti Morcha (JMM)

LOCKET CHATTERJEE
From: TMC to BJP in 2015
USP: Former film star and TMC's star campaigner, she is now BJP MP from Hooghly. BJP made her co-incharge of assembly polls in Uttarakhand

SAUMITRA KHAN
From: TMC to BJP in 2019
USP: Was among the first big names to switch to BJP and continues to stick with the party. He is the Lok Sabha MP from Bishnupur



Suvendu Adhikary

DEBAJYOTI CHAKRABORTY